

Lily

Some of the world's most impressive flowers are lilies. Their sweet perfume can fill a room. The tiger lily got its name from its orange and black petals, but in Asia there is also a legend that a tiger turned into one. Lilies disappear in the winter. They spend the cold months as an onion-shaped bulb underground. Each bulb is full of food, which the lily uses to grow when warm weather returns.

In the centre of a lily flower, you can see what look like tiny sausages on sticks. These are dusted in brown pollen. When an insect touches them, the pollen rubs off, and the insect flies away with it. This is how the pollen spreads from plant to plant to make seeds.

The tiger lily makes mini-bulbs at the base of its leaves, which can break off and grow into new lilies.



Tiger lily, Asia